

1.1.9 Jumpers

These refer to the open contacts on the motherboard that can be used to configure different settings of the board. With time, the number of jumpers has come down, with most of



Jumpers

its functionality shifted to the CMOS / BIOS. Still, many motherboards today do have one set of jumpers, which is used to reset the BIOS settings.

1.1.10 LAN port

RJ-45, or the LAN port, allows the PC to be connected to a network, whether to a LAN or to the Internet via a broadband modem.

1.1.11 Parallel port

The DB 25 or Parallel port is the traditional port for older printers. These are rarely seen today.

1.1.12 PCB (Printed Circuit Board)

The foundation of every electronic device is the board on which every component is connected. The PCB consists of minute conductors, usually of copper, seen as fine lines criss-crossing the surface, mounted on an insulated substrate. The minute pathways actually carry data signals or power between the various components that are eventually soldered on the PCB. PCBs come in various sizes and shapes, and besides the motherboard, are also seen in expansion cards (sound cards, graphics cards, etc.) and RAM modules.

1.1.13 PCI

Peripheral Component Interconnect is still widely seen in motherboards, though it is older than AGP. The wide availability of PCI